FROM TOKYO TO FOREIGN OFFICE

F 108

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Cypher /OTP

FOREIGN OFFICE AND WHITEHALL DISTRIBUTION

Sir R. Dening

No. 1781

15th December 1951.

D. 9.37 a.m. 15th December 1951.

R. 10.17 a.m. 15th December 1951.

F S 10310/41

IMMEDIATE

SECRET

Addressed to Foreign Office telegram No. 1781 of 15th December

Repeated for information to Washington.

My telegram No. 1772. F 10310/40

The Two Chinas.

Prime Minister was guest of honour last night at a dinner of Japan-British Society arranged some time ago over which I presided. As, in his speech, he took it upon himself to make a public reference to the need for Anglo-American cooperation on China, I tackled him after dinner and said I understood he had seen a memorandum by Mr. Dulles which had subsequently been shown to me. Mr. Yoshida affected at first not to understand what I was talking about. He then said that Mr. Dulles had read the memorandum to him and that his comment had been that, while Great Britain and the United States disagreed about China policy, it was impossible for Japan to take any action. He said he had expressed the hope that when Mr. Churchill visits Washington we and the United States will come to an agreement about our China policy, whereafter it will be easy for Japan to follow suit. I said it was easy for him to sit back and suggest that others should reach agreement, but what form would he like this agreement to take? On this he was not to be drawn.

/2. The conversation.....

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SECRET

Tokyo telegram No. 1781 to Foreign Office

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2. The conversation was an informal one but Mr. Yoshida's story certainly does not tally with that of Mr. Dulles. There appears to be a certain amount of American inspiration behind fairly numerous press reports to the effect that Japan will sign a treaty with Nationalist China, though some comment tends to follow the line which Mr. Yoshida has now taken twice with me. Mr. Dulles remains very bland in public, and a lengthy speech which he made at a luncheon yesterday gave no indication of the pressure he is seeking to exercise behind the scenes.

Foreign Office please pass to Washington as my telegram No. 111.

[Repeated to Washington].

ADVANCE COPIES

Sir W. Strang
Private Secretary
Mr. R.H.Scott
Head of China and Korea Department
Head of Japanese and Pacific Department

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